

EPISODE

West Hollywood · July 2026

FORMAT

Instagram Reel · 60 sec
edit

TALENT

WeHo local · 35–50 · 5+ yrs
resident

THE SETUP

WHERE TO FILM + HOW TO FRAME IT

Film them in motion — not sitting down. A coffee shop owner behind the counter, a resident walking their dog on Norma Place, a boutique owner arranging a display. The environment tells half the story before they say a word. Sit-down interviews feel like local news. You want them in their element.

- Stand 4–5 feet away. Close enough to feel intimate, far enough to show some environment behind them.
- Film vertical (portrait mode) for Stories and Reels. Landscape only if you plan to use it on Facebook too.
- Natural light only. Find a spot where light hits their face from the front, not behind them.
- Check audio before you start. Busy street = bad audio. Step inside or around a corner if needed.
- Let the camera run the whole time — even between questions. Candid moments between takes are often the best content.

BEFORE YOU HIT RECORD

SAY THIS WORD FOR WORD

"I'm not looking for a polished answer — I just want your honest take. If you stumble, that's fine, we'll just go again. Just talk to me like you're telling a friend."

That one line relaxes almost everyone. Don't show them the questions in advance — you want genuine first reactions, not rehearsed answers.

THE ANCHOR QUESTION

ALWAYS START HERE — THIS IS YOUR MONEY SHOT

"You've lived/worked in WeHo for [X] years. What's something about this neighborhood that an outsider would never know just from driving through?"

Let them finish completely. Don't jump in. The pause after they stop talking is where the gold usually comes out. Wait a full 3 seconds before asking the next question.

FOLLOW-UP QUESTIONS

USE 2–3 THAT FEEL NATURAL. DON'T USE ALL OF THEM.

1

"What made you stay? Like what was the moment you knew you weren't leaving?"

People love this one. It gets emotional fast and emotional = shareable.

2 "What's changed about the neighborhood that most people haven't noticed yet?"

Positions them as an insider. The answer is usually your most quotable line.

3 "If a friend told you they were thinking about buying here, what would you tell them that Zillow wouldn't?"

This one speaks directly to your buyer audience. Use this clip in your Week 3 market content too.

4 "What's your spot? The place you'd take someone on their first day in WeHo?"

Gets you a local recommendation you can use in your own content — bonus material.

THE CLOSE

ALWAYS END WITH THIS

Those three words are your caption, your text overlay, or your cover slide. Three words is quotable, shareable, and easy to put on screen. This is almost always the best clip in the whole interview.

AFTER THE INTERVIEW

BEFORE YOU PACK UP

- 1 Shoot 30 seconds of B-roll — them walking, at work, on the street. You need this to cut over their voice in the edit.
- 2 Get their Instagram handle. Tag them when it goes live — they'll reshare it to their audience.
- 3 Get verbal consent on camera. Just say "is it okay if I post this?" and let them say yes on the recording.
- 4 Send them the post when it's live. A personal message, not just a tag. They become a promoter.

TIMING GUIDE

HOW LONG TO SHOOT VS. EDIT TARGET

PHASE	TIME	NOTES
Pre-interview chat + setup	5–10 min	Relax them. Don't rush into recording.
Anchor question	2–3 min	Let them go long. You'll cut it down.
Follow-up questions (2–3)	5–7 min	Pick whichever feel natural in the moment.
The close (3 words)	1 min	Always do this one last.
B-roll of talent	3–5 min	Walking, at work, in the neighborhood.
Total shoot time	~20 min	You'll have 8–10 min of usable footage.
	60 seconds	That's all you need. Less is more.